

winning neighbours, the researchers also found an increase in borrowing, financial distress and bankruptcy levels.

My concern is that, sure, you probably don't have a lottery winner living next door, but thanks to social media and the sharing of our ever-increasing conspicuous consumption, we're comparing ourselves to peers and influencers (who aren't even buying the products they're peddling), who are potentially influencing us by sending us broke. Earlier we looked at who you could place in your life to increase your self-control and promote a positive financial environment. Now I want you to look at the reverse: Who do you need to *unfollow* in order to set up a healthy financial environment?

For example, when it comes to social media I follow a whole load of fashion brands and designers because I love clothes, shoes and overdressing. But I balance this by following people like Glennon Doyle, Elaine Welteroth, Elizabeth Gilbert, Brené Brown, Oprah Winfrey and other people I admire who help me stay grounded. But sometimes I'll consciously take a break from social media for a while or unfollow accounts if they're not financially healthy for me. I'll know if they're not financially healthy if I'm hitting 'Click to buy' more often, if my spending is increasing or if I don't feel that I'm the one leading my spending but rather I'm being too heavily influenced to spend. Certainly, twice a year I complete a 30-day financial detox where I don't buy anything new and during that time I unfollow or unsubscribe from anyone or anything that is putting my spending freeze in jeopardy. In other words, I control my online Money Environment.

Of course, figuring out if your financial environment is healthy or unhealthy is only the first step. If your environment is positive and healthy, the next question is: How can you amplify those effects? Or, if you've acknowledged your financial environment is unhelpful or negative, how do you step out of it?

Some of you may struggle to answer these questions—you may be concerned you're stuck in a Money Environment with no way out. The good news is: you're not.

Three powerful tools that can help you set up a positive Money Environment for yourself are differentiation, self-reliance and our old friend self-control.